Mahatma Gandhi University, Kottayam-

Third Semester MGU-UGP – BSW (Honours) Regular Examination October 2025

Value Addition Course(VAC) - MG3VACSWK200 - Gender Diversity and Inclusion

QP Code: 25900635

Part A Short Answer Questions Answer any 5 questions / each question carries 2 marks

1	Mention two features of patriarchy. 1. **Male dominance:** Men hold primary power in social, political, and economic spheres. 2. **Gender hierarchy:** Women are often assigned subordinate roles and limited decision-making authority.	U]/[CO1] 2 marks
2	State two functions of religious as a social institution. 1. **ocial cohesion:** Religion unites people through shared beliefs and rituals. 2. **Moral guidance:** It provides ethical values that regulate individual and group behavior.	[K]/ [CO1] 2 marks
3	Describe NLASA Act. The **NALSA (National Legal Services Authority) Act, 1987** aims to provide free legal aid to the poor and marginalized, ensuring access to justice for all. It also oversees Lok Adalats and promotes legal awareness.	[U]/ [CO3] 2 marks
4	Recognize one international campaign that promotes gender equity. **UN Women's "HeForShe" Campaign** – launched in 2014, it encourages men and boys to support gender equality and women's empowerment.	[U]/ [CO4] 2 marks
5	Define the term gender affirmation. Gender affirmation refers to the process through which a person's gender identity is recognized and respected—socially, legally, and medically—according to their self-identified gender.	[K]/ [CO4] 2 marks
6	Give a short note on division of labour at home. Division of labour at home refers to how household tasks are shared among family members. Traditionally, women handle domestic chores and caregiving, while men focus on income generation. Modern views encourage equal and shared responsibilities	[U]/ [CO2] 2 marks
7	Give an example of gender sensitivity in daily life. Treating both boys and girls equally in education, opportunities, and decision-making—for example, encouraging both sons and daughters to pursue higher education and share household tasks.	U]/[CO2 2 marks]

Part B Short Essay -Answer any 4 questions / each question carries 5 marks

8	Explain how gender budgeting promotes gender equity in India. ➢ **Definition:** Gender budgeting is a tool that ensures government budgets address the specific needs of women and men equitably. ➢ **Policy Integration:** It incorporates gender perspectives in planning, allocation, and evaluation of public spending. ➢ **Empowerment Focus:** Directs funds to schemes promoting women's health, education, livelihood, and safety. ➢ **Examples:** Ministries like Rural Development and Health include gender-responsive schemes such as *Beti Bachao Beti Padhao* and *Mahila E-Haat*. ➢ **Outcome:** Helps reduce gender gaps by promoting inclusive growth, resource access, and equal participation in development.	[U]/ [CO4] 1 mark for each point=5 marks
9	Compare the objectives of GEI and GII.	[U]/ [CO1] 1 mark for each point=5 marks
10	Express the value of equal pay policies in closing the gender gap.	[U]/

Aspect	Gender Empowerment Index (GEI)	Gender Inequality Index (GII)
Objective	Measures women's participation in political and economic life.	Measures gender-based disadvantage across health, empowerment, and labour.
Focus Areas	Political representation, income, and professional opportunities.	Maternal health, adolescent birth rates, education, and representation.
Goal	Highlight women's empowerment and participation.	Highlight inequality between men and women.
Interpretation	Higher value = more empowerment.	Higher value = more inequality.
Use	Guides empowerment policies.	Identifies gender disparities needing intervention.

	➢ **Definition:** Equal pay policies ensure men and women receive the same remuneration for the same or equivalent work. ➢ **Economic Justice:** Promotes fairness and acknowledges women's contribution to the workforce. ➢ **Empowerment:** Increases women's economic independence and decision-making power. ➢ **Reduced Discrimination:** Discourages biased hiring and occupational segregation. ➢ **Example:** *Equal Remuneration Act (1976)* in India promotes wage parity, supporting Sustainable Development Goal 5 on gender equality.	[CO6] 1 mark for each point=5 marks
11	Explain femininity as a cultural construct. ➢ **Definition:** Femininity refers to traits, roles, and behaviors culturally associated with being female. ➢ **Cultural Basis:** Defined by social norms and expectations rather than biology. ➢ **Variation:** Varies across societies and time—what is considered "feminine" in one culture may differ in another. ➢ **Impact:** Shapes gender roles, beauty standards, and career choices. ➢ **Example:** Caring, emotional expression, and modesty are often promoted as "feminine" traits through socialization.	[U]/ [CO1] 1 mark for each point=5 marks
12	Discuss how sex influences social identity. ➢ **Definition:** Sex refers to biological differences (male, female, intersex), while social identity is shaped by social roles and expectations. ➢ **Role Assignment:** Societies assign different responsibilities and privileges based on sex. ➢ **Socialization:** From birth, individuals are taught behaviors aligning with their sex (e.g., girls nurtured for caregiving roles). ➢ **Inequality:** Creates hierarchies and stereotypes that can limit opportunities. ➢ **Relevance:** Recognizing this helps promote equality and challenge rigid gender norms.	[U]/ [CO2] 1 mark for each point=5 marks
13	Describe reforms in medieval India addressing gender. ➢ **Bhakti Movement:** Saints like Mirabai and Akka Mahadevi challenged caste and gender barriers through spiritual expression. ➢ **Social Reformers:** Basavanna and Kabir promoted equality and condemned gender discrimination. ➢ **Religious Equality:** Women saints gained recognition as spiritual leaders, breaking patriarchal norms. ➢ **Education:** Some reformers supported women's access to learning through religious teachings. ➢ **Impact:** Though limited, these movements sowed early seeds for women's dignity and equality.	[U]/ [CO2] 1 mark for each point=5 marks
14	Discuss role of missionaries in women's education. ➢ **Early Efforts:** Christian missionaries in the 19th century established schools for girls in India. ➢ **Curriculum:** Focused on literacy, moral education, and later vocational and teacher training. ➢ **Key Contributors:** Organizations like the *Serampore Mission* and *Madras Mission* pioneered girls' schools. ➢ **Social Impact:** Empowered women to enter professions like teaching and nursing. ➢ **Legacy:** Helped challenge orthodox restrictions and laid the foundation for women's educational advancement in India.	[U]/ [CO1] 1 mark for each point=5 marks

Part C Short Essay -Answer any2 questions / each question carries 10 marks

15	Employ community participation to tackle gender inequity at the local level. ➢ **Awareness Building:** Conduct community meetings and campaigns to challenge discriminatory gender norms. ➢ **Inclusion in Local Governance:** Ensure women's representation in *Panchayati Raj Institutions* and local committees. ➢ **Capacity Building:** Provide leadership and skill training to empower women for active participation. ➢ **Participatory Planning:** Involve both men and women in identifying community needs and priorities. ➢ **Economic Empowerment:** Form self-help groups (SHGs) to enhance women's income and decision-making power.	A/ [CO5] 1 mark for each point= 10marks

	➢ **Education Initiatives:** Encourage community-based adult literacy programs for women and girls. ➢ **Health and Safety:** Promote gender-sensitive community health services and awareness on reproductive rights. ➢ **Collaboration with NGOs:** Partner with local organizations for advocacy and capacity development. ➢ **Cultural Change:** Use local media, street plays, and folk art to challenge gender stereotypes. ➢ **Monitoring and Evaluation:** Engage community members in assessing progress toward gender equality goals.	
16	Examine how stereo types reinforce inequality. ➢ **Rigid Role Expectations:** Men are seen as breadwinners, women as homemakers, limiting opportunities. ➢ **Education Barriers:** Girls are often discouraged from pursuing science or leadership roles. ➢ **Workplace Discrimination:** Women face the "glass ceiling" and wage gaps due to biased assumptions. ➢ **Media Representation:** Stereotypical portrayals of women as dependent and emotional reinforce inferiority. ➢ **Cultural Practices:** Traditions like dowry and son preference reflect deep-rooted gender bias. ➢ **Political Underrepresentation:** Leadership is often viewed as a male domain. ➢ **Economic Dependence:** Gender roles limit women's access to property and credit. ➢ **Violence Justification:** Stereotypes sometimes normalize control or abuse against women. ➢ **Internalization:** Both men and women internalize stereotypes, reproducing them unconsciously. ➢ **Breaking the Cycle:** Education, awareness, and gender-sensitive media can challenge these stereotypes	[U]/ [CO1] 1 mark for each point= 10marks
17	Demonstrate how CEDAW promotes equal rights for women in education. ➢ **Article 10 Commitment:** Ensures equal access to education at all levels for girls and women. ➢ **Non-Discrimination Clause:** Prohibits exclusion from schools based on gender or marital status. ➢ **Curriculum Equality:** Promotes elimination of gender bias in textbooks and teaching methods. ➢ **Vocational and Technical Training:** Encourages women's participation in non-traditional fields. ➢ **Scholarships and Support:** Urges states to provide financial aid to increase women's access. ➢ **Dropout Prevention:** Recommends measures to reduce female dropout rates, especially due to early marriage. ➢ **Teacher Training:** Supports gender-sensitivity training for educators. ➢ **Adult Education:** Encourages literacy and lifelong learning opportunities for women. ➢ **Monitoring by States:** Requires periodic reporting on educational progress for women. ➢ **Impact in India:** Influenced policies like *Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan*, *Beti Bachao Beti Padhao*, and gender-inclusive curricula.	A/ [CO4] 1 mark for each point= 10marks
18	Critically discuss gender identity and orientation. ➢ G**ender Identity:** Refers to an individual's personal sense of being male, female, both, or neither. ➢ **Biological vs. Social:** While sex is biological, gender identity is shaped by psychological and social factors. ➢ **Orientation Defined:** Sexual orientation refers to the pattern of emotional, romantic, or sexual attraction (e.g., heterosexual, homosexual, bisexual, asexual). ➢ **Cultural Influence:** Society defines acceptable gender roles, influencing identity expression. ➢ **Transgender and Non-binary Identities:** Challenge binary notions of gender and demand recognition. ➢ **Discrimination:** People with diverse gender identities often face stigma, violence, and exclusion. ➢ **Legal Protection:** India's *Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Act, 2019* upholds the right to self-identify one's gender.	[U]/ [CO1] 1 mark for each point= 10marks

	➢ **Human Rights Perspective:** Gender identity and orientation are integral to dignity, equality, and freedom. ➢ **Education and Awareness:** Inclusive curricula and sensitization reduce prejudice and promote acceptance. ➢ **Critical View:** True equality requires going beyond tolerance to celebrate gender diversity as part of human identity.	